Vendor Questions/Answers

1. Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research.1784735278666. Section B. Item 3. Format instructions; page 1

   Would the Government be acceptable to 9pt font in the Arial family for tables and graphics only?

   Answer: Yes

2. Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research.1784735278666 & Att 3_Pricing Template_.1784735282818. Section E. Volume III – Price; page 6

   The pricing instructions require Offerors to include GSA SINs per labor category as well as any pricing assumptions and a statement confirming their GSA Schedule(s) will remain active for the proposed term within the LCAT Pricing Table (Price Volume). However, there is no designated place in Att 3_Pricing Template to provide this information, and these responses are more aligned to a narrative structure.

   Would the Government be acceptable to Offerors including this within a supplemental Pricing Narrative, rather than the Pricing Table?

   Answer: Yes, it is acceptable to include this within a supplemental pricing narrative. Please note this in the proposal.

3. Optimizing Intramural Science RFQ DRAFT.1784735104740 & Att 3_Pricing Template_.1784735282818. Part III – Contract Administration Information; Section 5. Travel; page 9

   The RFQ states in Part III Section 5 that “No travel is anticipated.” The pricing template also does not currently include a line item for Other Direct Costs (ODCs) such as travel. However, this contract has historically required travel for some staff at the Government’s direction and approval.

Would the Government be acceptable to Offerors including an Other Direct Costs (ODC) line item within their pricing volume to account for an estimate of these costs?

Answer: Yes

4. Att. 1_Optimizing Intramural Research Support Services SOW.1784735259167 & Att 3_Pricing Template_.1784735282818. SOW Section 3.5 OPTIONAL TASK – SURGE CAPACITY AND SPECIAL PROJECTS; page 13

   Currently, the Pricing Template does not account for any optional contract line item number (CLIN) funding. SOW Task Area 5 further indicates that work under this task area shall be "funded through contract modification or within existing ceiling as appropriate" – omitting any funding for the optional task in the Pricing Template is likely to eliminate, or at best reduce, the Government's ability to exercise new funds for these tasks in the future.

   Would the Government be acceptable to Offerors including pricing for Optional Task 5's optional Laboratory Manager and up to 3 optional Project Managers as part of their pricing submission? This would ensure appropriate optional funding is included in the contract ceiling, thereby mitigating future budgetary risks and administrative burden for the government.

   Answer: Yes

5. Optimizing Intramural Science RFQ DRAFT.1784735104740 & Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research. 1784735278666. RFQ Section 3. Quote Submission; Item C.; page 3

   The RFQ states that "electronic copies of the Technical and Price-Cost Quotes shall be submitted", however the evaluation criteria and instructions in Att 2 refer to three individual "volumes" without specifying how they should be assembled.

   Is it correct to assume that Offerors should deliver a Technical Quote – comprising Volumes I & II (Technical & Management Approach and Past Performance) – and a Price-Cost Quote (Volume III Price)?

Answer: Yes, deliver a Technical Quote comprised of Volumes I & II (Technical & Management Approach and Past Performance) – and a Price-Cost Quote (Volume III Price

6. Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research.1784735278666. Section B. Submission Structure and Administrative Requirements; Item 4. Page limits; page 1

   The instructions for Key Personnel resumes do not currently allow for Offerors to include signed Letters of Intent (LOIs) for Key Personnel.

   Would the Government be acceptable to a 3-page limit total for Key Personnel resumes – 2 pages for each resume and 1 page for the LOI?

   Answer: Yes

7. Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research.1784735278666 Section C. Volume I – Technical & Management Approach; Factor II – Management, Staffing & Retention Plan; page 3

   Key Personnel are considered critical to the effective performance of the work to fulfill the requirements of the SOW. However, there is currently no requirement for Letters of Intent (LOIs) to be submitted as part of Key Personnel resumes. This introduces a risk to the Government's evaluation in scenarios where Offerors may submit proposed Key Personnel who are not actually available to perform on this contract.

   Would the Government please consider a mandatory requirement for signed LOIs to be submitted with Key Personnel resumes only?

   Answer: The government has not defined any positions as Key Personnel. If the offeror is defining a position as Key Personnel, then they may provide a LOI along with the Key Personnel as outlined in the Evaluation Criteria.

8. Att 2_Eval Criteria and Instructions Optimizing Intramural Research.1784735278666 Section I. Required Attachments Checklist; page 8

   The Required Attachments Checklist currently includes item 7. “COI/Ethics operations narrative (Volume I)”. This does not appear to be applicable to this contract’s scope and does not have any relevant evaluation criteria or instructions in the solicitation.

   Can the Government please confirm that this requirement has been included in error, and is not meant to be addressed by Offerors in their proposals for this contract?

   Answer: The requirement was not included in error. Offerors shall provide a brief COI/Ethics Operations Narrative in Volume I describing their processes for identifying, disclosing, avoiding, and mitigating actual or potential conflicts of interest, including organizational conflicts of interest, as well as applicable ethics, confidentiality, and oversight controls.

9. Att 3_Pricing Template_.1784735282818

   The Pricing Template includes a column for “Personnel Name” in each tab for the Base Period, Option 1, and Option 2. Would the Government be acceptable to Offerors using names such as “Project Manager III (TBD)” to address non-named personnel?

   Answer: Yes

10. Att. 1 SOW. (pg4. Section 3.2.1) Section Title - Shared Resource Core Operations

    Please list the equipment, tools, and technologies that NIH is currently utilizing and that you expect the contractor to manage.

    Answer:

BETA Center Makerspace Equipment list:

- Multi-material FDM 3D Printer

- High-temperature Delta 3D printer
- SLA (resin) 3D printer
- Digital Anatomy PolyJet 3D printer
- SLS Metal 3D printer
- Dry Electropolisher
- CO2 Laser Cutter
- Computer Workstations for CAD modeling
- UV Chamber
- Soldering Station
- Multimeter
- Signal Generator
- Oscilloscope
- Variable Power Supply
- Heated Stir Plate
- Various basic hand tools

11. Att. 1 SOW. (pgs.14 & 18-19 Section 3.6, 4.4) Section Title - Government Estimated LCAT Alignment by Task Area; Personnel Qualifications

    Is the Laboratory Manager listed in the LCAT table on p. 14 (Count 3, Task Area 2.2, SOW Section 3.2.2) the same position that is referred to as the Makerspace Manager (BETA Center) on pp. 18-19?

    Answer: Yes

12. Att. 1 SOW. (pgs.14 & 19 Section 3.6, 4.4) Section Title - Government Estimated LCAT Alignment by Task Area; Personnel Qualifications

    Is the Laboratory Tech/Coordinator III listed in the LCAT table on p. 14 (Count 4, Task Area 2.2, SOW Section 3.2.2) the same position that is referred to as the Makerspace Technician on p. 19?

Answer: Yes

13. Att. 1 SOW. (pgs.14-15 & 19 Section 3.6, 4.4) Section Title - Government Estimated LCAT Alignment by Task Area; Personnel Qualifications

    p.19 refers to a Microfabrication and Microfluidics Unit (MMU) Laboratory Technician / Laboratory Manager. However, this position does not appear in the LCAT table on pp. 14-15. There is a Research Laboratory Technician III (Count 7, Task Area 2.1, SOW Section 3.2.1), but the associated functional support is listed as "shared resource core support" rather than MMU Support. Will the Government please clarify this apparent discrepancy?

    Answer: The Research Laboratory Technician III positions may provide support to the Microfabrication and Microfluidics Unit (MMU), the Biomedical Engineering and Physical Science Shared Resource (BEPS), and other NIBIB IRP shared resources, as needed. Accordingly, the functional support is identified broadly as shared resource core support.

14. Att. 1 SOW. (pg.15 Section 3.6, 4.4) Section Title - Government Estimated LCAT Alignment by Task Area; Personnel Qualifications

    Will the Government please provide any contract specific qualifications for the Research Laboratory Technician III position (Count 7) if it differs from the qualifications included on p.19 for the MMU Laboratory Technician / Laboratory Manager requirements?

    Answer: The contract-specific qualifications for the Research Laboratory Technician III position do not differ from the MMU Laboratory Technician/Laboratory Manager qualifications identified on page 19.

15. Att. 1 SOW. (pg. 15 Section 3.6, 4.4) Section Title - Government Estimated LCAT Alignment by Task Area; Personnel Qualifications

Will the Government please provide any contract- specific qualifications for the Human Capital Analyst I positions (Counts 8, 9 & 10)?

Answer: The Human Capital Analyst I positions shall meet the general personnel requirements in SOW Section 4.4 and demonstrate experience supporting scientific programs, laboratory operations, and executive-level coordination within a research environment. No additional contract-specific education or years-of-experience requirements are prescribed.

16. Optimizing Intramural Science RFQ, Att. 1 SOW, and Att. 2 Evaluation Criteria and Instructions (RFP: p. 15; Att. 1: p. 17 Section RFP: Att. 1: 4.4; Att. 2: C) Section Title-RFQ: HHSAR 352.237-75 Key Personnel (December 2015); Att. 1: Personnel Qualifications; Att. 2: Factor II - Management, Staffing & Retention Plan

    The proposal instructions require key personnel resumes. However, no positions are designated as "key personnel" in the RFQ document or attachments. Does the Government require Offerors to designate key personnel? If so, does the Government have any additional requirements for the qualifications of key personnel, such as a specific number of key personnel or specialized experience?

    Answer: The Government has not designated any positions as Key Personnel and does not require Offerors to designate a specific number of Key Personnel. However, if an Offeror elects to identify a position as Key Personnel, the Offeror shall provide the applicable resume and letter of intent in accordance with the Evaluation Criteria. No additional qualification requirements apply beyond those stated in the solicitation.